IELTS SPEAKING PART 1

- **HOW TO ANSWER PART 1 QUESTIONS**

IELTS Speaking Part 1 questions are usually about familiar topics such as your home, work, studies, family, hobbies, food and daily life.

A strong answer should sound:

- **Natural**
- **Spontaneous**
- **Clear**
- **Personal**
- **Relevant**
- **Well-developed**

HIGH-LEVEL EXPRESSIONS

A. Instead of repeatedly saying "YES"

- **Absolutely**
- **Definitely**
- **Without a doubt**
- **Certainly**
- **Of course**
- **For sure**
- **By all means**
- **More often than not**

Example

Do you play sports?

Absolutely. I am a huge fan of cricket because it is both entertaining and competitive. Whenever I get the opportunity, I enjoy playing it with my friends.

B. Instead of repeatedly saying "NO"

- **Honestly speaking**
- **Quite honestly**
- **Not particularly**
- **Not really**
- **To be totally upfront**

- **I'm not particularly keen on...**
- **It's not really my cup of tea**
- **I wouldn't say so**

Example

- **Do you enjoy crowded places?**

Honestly speaking, I am not particularly fond of crowded places because I find them quite overwhelming. Having said that, I don't mind visiting busy places occasionally if I am with close friends.

C. Giving an Opinion

- **In my opinion...**
- **Personally, I think...**
- **From my perspective...**
- **As far as I'm concerned...**
- **To my way of thinking...**
- **I firmly believe...**
- **If you ask me...**
- **In my eyes...**

Example

- **Do you think parks are important?**

In my opinion, parks are extremely important because they provide people with much-needed open spaces in busy cities. They also give people an opportunity to relax and connect with nature.

<u>THE BAND 9 ANSWER FORMULA</u>

- **Formula 1: YES**

Direct Answer → Reason → Example → Personal Comment

- **Question: Do you like sports?**

Answer:
Absolutely. I am a huge fan of cricket because it is both entertaining and highly competitive. Whenever I get the opportunity, I enjoy playing it with my friends. I think it is also a great way to stay active and socialise.

- **Formula 2: NO**

Soft Negative → Reason → Exception

- **Question: Do you enjoy crowded places?**

Answer:
Honestly speaking, I am not particularly fond of crowded places because I find them quite overwhelming. Having said that, I don't mind visiting busy places occasionally if I am there with close friends.

- **Formula 3: OPINION**

Opinion → Reason → Development → Result

- **Question: Do you think education should be free?**

Answer:
In my eyes, making primary education free would be a significant step forward because it would give disadvantaged children greater access to education. On top of that, it could contribute to creating a more educated workforce in the long run.

IELTS SPEAKING PART 1 TOPICS

- **HOMETOWN**

Do you like your hometown?

Absolutely. I have a strong emotional attachment to my hometown because I spent most of my formative years there. I particularly appreciate the friendly atmosphere and the sense of community. Even though it has developed quite rapidly, it still retains much of its traditional charm.

Has your hometown changed much?

Yes, considerably. Over the past few years, there have been noticeable developments in terms of roads, buildings, businesses and public facilities. Although some of these changes have made life more convenient, I sometimes miss the quieter atmosphere it used to have.

Would you like to live there in the future?

I wouldn't rule it out. I think it would be wonderful to return there at some point, particularly when I have more time to enjoy a slower pace of life. However, for the foreseeable future, I would probably prefer to live somewhere with greater professional opportunities.

- **HOME AND ACCOMMODATION**

Do you live in a house or an apartment?

At the moment, I live in an apartment. It is relatively comfortable and has everything I need for my daily life. What I particularly like is that it is convenient and easy to maintain.

What is your favourite room?

Without a shadow of a doubt, my favourite place is my study area. It is where I can concentrate without too many distractions. I usually spend time there reading, working or simply planning my day.

Would you like to change anything about your home?

Definitely. I would probably make the space a little more spacious and add some greenery. I think plants can make an otherwise ordinary room feel much more welcoming and relaxing.

- **FAMILY**

Do you have a large family?

Not particularly. I come from a relatively small family, but we are quite close to one another. We may not see each other every day, but we make an effort to stay connected.

Who are you closest to in your family?

I would say I am particularly close to my immediate family. We have a very open relationship, so I can discuss both personal and professional matters with them. Their support has been extremely valuable to me over the years.

Do you often spend time with your family?

Whenever my schedule allows, yes. We usually spend time together during weekends or special occasions. Even something as simple as having a meal together gives us an opportunity to catch up.

- **FRIENDS**

Do you have many friends?

I have quite a few acquaintances, but only a handful of close friends. I believe the quality of a friendship matters far more than the number of people you know. I value friends who are trustworthy and genuinely supportive.

What do you usually do with your friends?

We normally meet for coffee, have a meal together or simply sit somewhere and talk. Sometimes we also go somewhere new because exploring different places together gives us something interesting to remember.

Do you prefer old friends or new friends?

I don't think I have to choose between the two. Old friends understand me because we have shared experiences, whereas new friendships can introduce me to different perspectives. I think both have their own value.

- **WORK**

What do you do?

I work in the education sector, where I am involved in supporting teaching and learning. A significant part of my work involves curriculum-related responsibilities and working with teachers. It can be demanding, but I find it genuinely rewarding.

What do you enjoy most about your work?

What I enjoy most is seeing progress. When I see a teacher become more confident or a student develop a new skill, it gives me a real sense of satisfaction. It makes the work feel meaningful rather than simply being a job.

Is your job difficult?

At times, certainly. There can be several responsibilities and deadlines competing for my attention. However, I have gradually learned to prioritise tasks and manage my time more effectively.

- **DAILY ROUTINE**

What is your daily routine like?

My routine is fairly structured. I usually start my day early, prepare for work and then spend most of the day dealing with professional responsibilities. In the evening, I try to relax, catch up on personal tasks and prepare for the following day.

Are you good at managing your time?

I would say I am reasonably good at it. I tend to plan my priorities in advance, particularly when I have several important tasks to complete. Of course, unexpected things sometimes come up, so I have to remain flexible.

Do you like having a fixed routine?

Generally speaking, yes. A routine gives me a sense of structure and helps me stay productive. However, I don't want every day to be identical because a little variety keeps life interesting.

- **WEEKENDS**

What do you usually do at weekends?

It varies. If I have had a particularly busy week, I usually take some time to rest and catch up on personal matters. If I am feeling energetic, I might meet friends, go somewhere interesting or work on something I enjoy.

Do you prefer busy weekends or relaxing weekends?

Honestly, I prefer a combination of both. I like having some plans because otherwise the weekend can feel unproductive, but I also need sufficient downtime to recharge before the new week begins.

Did you enjoy weekends when you were a child?

Definitely. Weekends felt much longer when I was a child. I had fewer responsibilities, so I could spend hours playing, watching television or visiting relatives without worrying about deadlines.

- **MUSIC**

Do you like listening to music?

Absolutely. Music is one of the easiest ways for me to change my mood. I often listen to it while travelling or working, although the type of music I choose depends on how I am feeling.

What kind of music do you enjoy?

I have fairly diverse tastes, but I tend to prefer music with meaningful lyrics and a pleasant melody. I don't necessarily stick to one particular genre because my preferences change depending on the situation.

Has your taste in music changed?

Yes, quite a bit. When I was younger, I mainly listened to whatever was popular among my friends. Nowadays, I pay more attention to the lyrics and overall quality rather than simply following trends.

- **SPORTS**

Do you like sports?

Obviously. I think sports are a great combination of entertainment, physical activity and social interaction. I particularly enjoy watching cricket, and whenever I have the opportunity, I like playing it with friends.

Did you play sports as a child?

Yes, quite frequently. I spent a lot of time outdoors playing different games with friends. Looking back, I think those activities were an important part of my childhood because they taught me cooperation and healthy competition.

Do you prefer watching or playing sports?

I enjoy both, but if I had to choose, I would probably prefer playing. Watching a match can be exciting, but actually participating gives me a much stronger sense of involvement.

- **READING**

Do you enjoy reading?

Definitely. I see reading as a way of continuously learning and broadening my perspective. I particularly enjoy material that introduces me to new ideas or gives me practical knowledge.

How often do you read?

I try to read regularly, although the amount varies depending on my workload. On quieter days, I can spend quite a bit of time reading, whereas during particularly busy periods, I may only manage a few pages.

Did you read much as a child?

Yes. I used to enjoy storybooks because they allowed me to use my imagination. I think that early exposure to books also helped me develop a genuine interest in learning.

- **MOBILE PHONES**

Do you use your mobile phone a lot?

Quite honestly, yes. I use it for communication, work-related matters, navigation, reading and entertainment. It has become such an integral part of modern life that going without it for an entire day would be rather difficult.

What do you mainly use your phone for?

Communication is probably the main purpose. I also use it to check emails, access information, manage my schedule and occasionally watch educational content. So, for me, it is much more than a device for making calls.

Would you like to spend less time on your phone?

Yes, definitely. Although it is extremely useful, it can also be distracting. I sometimes find myself checking notifications unnecessarily, so I think reducing screen time would help me focus better.

- **SOCIAL MEDIA**

Do you use social media?

Yes, but I try to use it selectively. I mainly use social media to stay connected with people, follow educational content and keep up with interesting developments. I don't want it to consume too much of my time.

What do you like about social media?

The biggest advantage is accessibility. You can connect with people from different backgrounds and access information almost instantly. It can also be useful professionally, particularly for sharing ideas and learning from others.

Are there any disadvantages?

Certainly. One major concern is that people can become overly dependent on it. It can also create distractions and sometimes expose users to unreliable information, so I think people need to use it critically and responsibly.

- **WEATHER**

What kind of weather do you like?

I particularly enjoy mild, slightly cool weather. It is much easier to concentrate and be active when the temperature is comfortable. I also find that pleasant weather makes outdoor activities much more enjoyable.

Does the weather affect your mood?

To some extent, yes. Bright and pleasant weather generally makes me feel more energetic, whereas extremely hot or gloomy weather can make me feel less motivated.

Do you like rainy weather?

Yes, occasionally. I find the sound of rain quite relaxing, particularly when I am indoors with a cup of tea or a good book. However, heavy rain can be inconvenient when I have to travel.

- **TRAVEL**

Do you like travelling?

Absolutely. Travelling gives me the opportunity to experience different cultures, meet new people and see places that are completely different from my everyday surroundings. I also think it teaches you to become more adaptable.

Do you prefer travelling alone or with others?

I generally prefer travelling with a small group of people I know well. Sharing experiences makes the journey more enjoyable, and there is always someone to talk to or help with practical matters.

Where would you like to travel in the future?

There are several places I would love to visit. Ideally, I would choose somewhere with a combination of natural beauty, history and culture because I enjoy trips where I can both relax and learn something new.

- **PHOTOGRAPHY**

Do you like taking photos?

Yes, especially when I am travelling or attending an important event. I think photographs are a wonderful way of preserving memories. Years later, a single photograph can bring back details that you might otherwise have forgotten.

Do you prefer taking photos or having your photo taken?

I would say taking photos. I enjoy capturing interesting moments, particularly candid ones. However, I obviously appreciate having photographs of myself when I am visiting somewhere special.

Do you take many photos with your phone?

Yes, probably more than I realise. Since my phone is always with me, it is incredibly convenient to capture something interesting whenever I see it. I don't necessarily share all the photos; sometimes I simply keep them as personal memories.

- **COOKING**

Can you cook?

Yes, I can prepare a few basic dishes reasonably well. I wouldn't describe myself as an expert, but I can certainly manage when necessary. I actually enjoy cooking when I have enough time and don't feel rushed.

Who usually cooks in your home?

It depends on the day. When everyone is busy, we tend to keep meals simple, but when there is more time, cooking becomes more of a shared activity.

Would you like to learn to cook better?

Without a shadow of a doubt. I think cooking is an extremely useful life skill. I'd particularly like to learn how to prepare a wider range of healthy dishes rather than relying on the same few recipes.

- **SHOPPING**

Do you enjoy shopping?

It depends on what I am shopping for. I enjoy shopping when I have a clear purpose and know what I need, but I am not particularly interested in wandering around shops for hours without a plan.

Do you prefer shopping online or in stores?

I tend to prefer online shopping for convenience. It saves time and makes it easy to compare different options. However, for certain products, particularly clothes, I still prefer visiting a physical store because I can check the quality and fit myself.

Do you often buy things you don't need?

Honestly, not very often. I usually think carefully before making a purchase, especially if it is expensive. I try to distinguish between something I genuinely need and something that simply catches my attention temporarily.

- **PARKS**

Do you often visit parks?

Not as often as I would like, but I enjoy visiting them whenever I have the opportunity. Parks provide a welcome break from busy urban environments and give people a chance to spend time outdoors.

What do people usually do in parks?

People use parks for a variety of purposes. Some go there for exercise, while others take their children to play or simply sit and socialise. In the evenings, parks can become particularly lively.

Do you think parks are important?

Absolutely. They provide much-needed open spaces in increasingly crowded cities. Apart from offering recreational opportunities, they can also contribute to people's overall quality of life by providing a place to relax and connect with nature.

- **GIFTS**

Do you like receiving gifts?

Of course. I think everyone appreciates receiving a thoughtful gift, but for me, the meaning behind the gift matters more than its price. Something simple can be extremely valuable if it shows that someone genuinely knows you.

Do you enjoy giving gifts?

Yes, probably even more than receiving them. I like thinking about what would make someone happy and choosing something that suits their personality. Seeing their reaction is often the most rewarding part.

What was the best gift you have received?

One of the most memorable gifts I've received was something quite simple but very personal. What made it special was the thought that went into it rather than its monetary value. That is why I still remember it.

- **CHILDHOOD**

Did you enjoy your childhood?

Definitely. I have many fond memories of my childhood, particularly the time I spent with friends and family. Life was much simpler then, and I didn't have to worry about professional responsibilities or long-term decisions.

What did you enjoy doing as a child?

I enjoyed playing outdoors, spending time with friends and exploring new things. I think children naturally have a strong sense of curiosity, and I was no different.

Would you like to be a child again?

In some ways, yes. Childhood was certainly less stressful and more carefree. However, I also appreciate the independence and opportunities that come with adulthood, so I wouldn't necessarily want to go back permanently.

- **<u>USEFUL BAND 9 PHRASES</u>**

Expressing Preference

- **I tend to prefer...**
- **I am particularly fond of...**
- **I have a preference for...**
- **I generally gravitate towards...**
- **What I particularly enjoy is...**
- **What appeals to me most is...**

Giving Reasons

- **Mainly because...**
- **One of the main reasons is that...**
- **What I particularly like is...**
- **The main advantage is...**
- **Another reason is that...**

Adding Examples

- **For instance...**
- **For example...**
- **A good example would be...**
- **To give you an example...**
- **Take ... for example.**

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Contrasting Ideas

- **Having said that...**
- **That being said...**
- **On the other hand...**
- **At the same time...**
- **Nevertheless...**
- **Even so...**

Talking About Change

- **Over the years...**
- **Compared with the past...**
- **These days...**
- **Nowadays...**
- **In recent years...**
- **My perspective has changed considerably...**

Talking About Frequency

- **From time to time...**
- **Every now and then...**
- **More often than not...**
- **On a regular basis...**
- **Whenever I get the opportunity...**
- **As often as I can...**

<u>IMPORTANT IELTS STRATEGY</u>

Note: *Do not memorise the answer.*

Should memorise:

Expressions + Structures + Vocabulary

Should NOT memorise:

Complete Answers

A memorised answer can sound unnatural if the examiner changes the question slightly.

The goal:

Learn the language → Understand the structure → Personalise the answer → Speak naturally

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QUICK PRACTICE MODEL

For every Part 1 question, students should try to produce:

Level 1

Direct answer

Level 2

Direct answer + reason

Level 3

Direct answer + reason + example

Level 4

Direct answer + reason + example + personal comment

Example

Do you like reading?

Level 1:
Yes, I do.

Level 2:
Absolutely. I enjoy reading because it helps me learn new things.

Level 3:
Absolutely. I enjoy reading because it helps me learn new things. I particularly like books about education and personal development.

Level 4:
Absolutely. I enjoy reading because it helps me learn new things and broaden my perspective. I particularly like books about education and personal development. Whenever I have some free time, I try to read for at least a few minutes because I find it both useful and relaxing.

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FINAL REMINDER

- **Don't give one-word answers.**
- **Don't memorise complete scripts.**
- **Don't force difficult vocabulary.**
- **Don't use the same expression in every answer.**

Instead:

Answer → Explain → Develop → Personalise

The objective is not to sound complicated.

The objective is to sound natural, fluent, precise and confident.